

⌈  $p$ -Group.

Thm. Let  $G$  be a Group of order  $p^n$  for some prime  $p, n \in \mathbb{N}$ .

Then,  $G$  has a Normal Series  $\{P_i\}_{i=0}^n$  such that

$$1 = P_0 \triangleleft P_1 \triangleleft \dots \triangleleft P_{n-1} \triangleleft P_n = G. \quad (|P_i| = p^i)$$

Proof. First,  $Z(G) \neq 1$  because The Class Equation: if  $Z(G) = 1$ ,

$$p^n = |G| = |Z(G)| + \sum |G : G(g_i)| = 1 + \sum p^{r_i} \quad (1 \leq r_i \leq n-1)$$

This implies  $p$  divides 1, Contradiction.

Now, Using induction:

For  $n=2$ ,

$|G/Z(G)| = p$  or 1, thus it must be cyclic, this implies  $G$  is Abelian.

By Cauchy's Thm,  $G$  has a subgroup of order  $p$ , thus Claim is satisfied.

For  $n \geq 2$ , suppose the claim is true.

Let  $|G| = p^{n+1}$ . Since  $1 \subsetneq Z(G)$  and Cauchy Thm,

there exists a Normal Subgroup  $N \trianglelefteq G$  in  $Z(G)$  with order  $p$ .

Now,  $G/N$  is a Group of order  $p^n$ , by hypothesis,  $G/N$  has a Normal Series:

$$1 = N/N \triangleleft N_1/N \triangleleft \dots \triangleleft N_{n-1}/N \triangleleft N_n/N = G/N.$$

The fourth Isomorphism gives  $N_{n-1} \trianglelefteq G$  and  $|N_{n-1}| = p^n$ , the claim is proved.

Lemma.  $G/Z(G)$  is cyclic  $\Leftrightarrow G$  is Abelian. D

Proof. Suppose  $G/Z(G)$  is cyclic. Put  $xZ(G)$  be a generator of  $G/Z(G)$ .

Let  $a, b \in G$  be given. Then, for some  $m, n \in \mathbb{Z}$ ,

$$aZ(G) = x^m Z(G), \quad bZ(G) = x^n Z(G).$$

Now,  $ax^m, bx^n \in Z(G)$ .

$$ab = ax^{-m} x^m bx^{-n} x^n = x^{m+n}. \quad bx^{-n} ax^{-m} = ba.$$